

8.3.2 YouTube (www.youtube.com)

YouTube is a great place for every comp-pota-to. It is by far the most popular free video host on the planet, and its popularity is growing by the minute.



Currently, it gets over 70 million hits a day! Being a pioneer in its field, it has had several of its features copied in other video hosts. YouTube lets you upload your video onto its server and allows it to be viewed (without downloading on your computer) right on the site.

You need to register to upload a video. Once you're registered, you can upload as many videos as you like, in almost all formats. YouTube recommends, though, that you should upload videos in the MPEG-4 format at a resolution of 320 x 240. There is a file size restriction, however: you can only upload up to a 100 MB at a time, up to a maximum time of 10 minutes. If you want to upload a video longer than 10 minutes, you will either have to upload it in several parts, or get a Director account—which is available free of charge to film directors, animators and the like.

When uploading videos, YouTube gives you the option of adding tags so your video can easily be accessed. The greater and more descriptive the tags, the higher the chance that your video will be found. In fact, some people add all sorts of irrelevant and unrelated tags to their videos just so their video will show up on search results. Try not to do that. Let your video speak for itself (§8.4).